Elia Acciai

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Education

University of Turin & Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin
PhD in Economics Nov. 2023 - Present
Supervisors: Marina Della Giusta and Juan F. Vargas
Research interests: Economics of Crime and Conflict, Cultural Economics, Development Economics, and AI & ML

Catholic University of the Sacred Heart, Milan
MSc in Economics, Markets, and Financial Institutions - Finance 2019 - 2022
Final grade: 110/110 cum laude

University of Florence, Florence
BSc in Economics and Business 2016 - 2019

Work Experience

The World Bank, Washington D.C.
Consultant at the Development Research Group Sept. 2026 - Present
Sponsor: Sandra V. Rozo

University of Turin, Turin
Research Assistant for Michele Belloni, Marina Della Giusta, and Giovanna Segre Jun. 2023 - Oct. 2023

Research Assistant for Michele Belloni, Marina Della Giusta, and Giovanna Segre Nov. 2022 - May 2023

Lavoce.info, Milan
Research Assistant Nov. 2022 - Sept. 2023
Writing economic and policy articles
Data collection and verification for editorial content
Fact-checking and data visualization

Accenture, Milan
Internship - Strategy & Consulting (Banking Sector) Oct. 2021 - Apr. 2022

Working Papers

Blood Antiquities: What Images Reveal about the Market for Cultural Heritage

Art of Deterrence: The Unintended Effects of Public Art

Work In Progress

Explaining the Fertility Decline: Evidence from Colombia (with L. Peñaloza-Pacheco and S. Rozo)

The Beautiful Fields: Unexpected Consequences of Foreign Aid in Afghanistan (with E. Corso)

Publications

Journal Articles

- *Illicit Shadows: The Cultural Goods Trade Gap for Italy* (with M. Belloni, M. Della Giusta, and G. Segre), **Journal of Cultural Economics**, 2025. DOI: 10.1007/s10824-025-09555-z

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026: 12th European Workshop on Applied Cultural Economics, Porto, Portugal Sept. 9 - 11

	IV Sapienza Ph.D. Conference in Social Sciences and Economics, Rome, Italy	Sept. 3 - 4
	"Text-as-data" in Economics Workshop, Bath, United Kingdom	July 16 - 17
	10th International PhD Meeting in Economics, Thessaloniki, Greece	July 10 - 11
	Armenian Economic Association Annual Meeting, Yerevan, Armenia	June 29 - July 1
	VPDE Internal PhD Forum, Turin, Italy	March 23 - 24
2025:	VPDE Internal PhD Forum, Turin, Italy	April 10 - 11

Other Relevant Training

Illicit Trafficking of Cultural Property, Istituto per l'Arte e il Restauro - Palazzo Spinelli (2026)

Twenty-Fourth Summer School in International and Development Economics: "Geo-economics, Natural Resources, and Development", Centro Studi Luca d'Agliano (2025)

Regression Discontinuity Designs in Development Economics: Theory and Practice, Barcelona School of Economics (2024)

Bloomberg Market Concepts, Bloomberg LP (2020)

Workshops and Conferences Organized

18th UniTO-Collegio Carlo Alberto PhD Workshop in Economics November 19-21, 2025

Service

PhD Student Representative, Dept. of Economics and Statistics "Cognetti de Martiis", University of Turin December 2024 - Present

Programming and IT Knowledge

Advanced: Deep Learning, LaTeX, Microsoft Office, Python, QGIS, Web Scraping, Stata
Intermediate: MATLAB, R

Languages

English (Fluent)
French (Basic)
Italian (Native)

References

Marina Della Giusta
Collegio Carlo Alberto Affiliate
Full professor in Economics
Department of Economics and Statistics "Cognetti de Martiis"
University of Turin
marina.dellagiusta@unito.it

Juan F. Vargas
Collegio Carlo Alberto, Carlo Alberto Chair
Full professor in Economics
ESOMAS, Department of Economics
University of Turin
juan.vargas@carloalberto.org

Sandra V. Rozo
Senior Economist
Development Research Group
The World Bank Group
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